

Where to write in

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Agent 001

Q I plan to buy a laptop soon which will be used for website designing, database management and Java programming. I am confused between two brands — Dell and Lenovo. My budget is around Rs. 35,000 and I'd like to get at least a Core 2 duo and at least 2GB RAM. Also, it would be good if it comes with genuine Windows 7. I give equal importance to after purchase service of the product and I'm not aware of any Dell service center here, in Kolkata. Please help me on this.

Rupanjana Chatterjee

A I think from among the two brands you have mentioned you will find only Pentium Dual Cores for that price range. For a little more, and as little as Rs. 37,000 or so, you can pick up a notebook from Lenovo with 3 GB of RAM and a decent Core 2 Duo in the range of the T6600 (2.2 GHz).

Q I want to buy a 19-22 inch LCD monitor; that doubles as a TV. Budget is around Rs. 13,000

Manish Saini

A Look at the LG M197WA, we have tested the 22-inch version (Rs. 12,990) and it was pretty decent.

Q I was planning to buy a cellphone, probably a touch screen, with a decent camera with flash and at least 1 GB of inbuilt or bundled memory space (expandable memory). It should also have a music player, FM receiver, Bluetooth receiver, Wi-Fi support, Internet support and should be able to record videos at a minimum resolution of 480p. Plus the internal phone memory space should also be sufficient. The battery life should also be sufficient to last at-least a day. My first choice is Nokia phones. A similiar phone from any company would be equally acceptable. My budget is Rs. 10,000 and I cannot spend any more.

Saurabh Mittal

A 480p video recording is a little tough to find on your budget, but if you want a decent phone that has touch capabilities I

suggest the LG KS660, although it will be priced above the Rs. 10,000 mark. Nokia's 5230 is priced at Rs. 10,000 and has a touch screen, it also has a good battery and display, but a very ordinary camera. Other than that you have the option of non-touch phones. In such a case look at Sony Ericsson's W595, also priced at the 10K mark.

Q I'm all set to purchase a new LCD 32-inch. I have picked Sony as a brand because I've heard their TVs are better, but I'm really confused between two models. The models in question are the Sony Bravia KLV-32W550A and KLV-32V550A/B. Which is better and is there anything else I can consider?

Ravi D

A Amongst the two HDTVs former has a 100 Hz display, but this does not justify the price difference of Rs. 16,000 or so. You are better off with the KLV-32V550A/B. May I also recommend 32PFL5609/98, available for around Rs. 40,000. This is a full HD display (1080p) and is pretty good value for the performance it offers.

Q My current PC configuration is:-
Motherboard: Gigabyte 945GCM-S2L
RAM: 2 GB
Processor: Intel Core 2 Duo E7500 2.93Ghz
Graphics card: Nvidia GeForce 7300/7200 GS 512Mb

This configuration is enough according to the recommended configuration needed for games like Batman Arkham Asylum, Crysis and applications like Maya etc. But still these games and applications are not running to their full capacity on my PC. Is it because my graphics card is old? If yes, are there any better (and less expensive) options available for my current motherboard? Or would I have to give my system a complete overhaul?

Shobhit Khinvasara

A The answer is an emphatic yes. You haven't mentioned a budget so I'm going to assume you will be willing to spend at least Rs. 4,000. For that price you can pick up a GeForce 9600GT from brands like ZOTAC and Palit. If you can spend Rs. 6,500 or so, you can pick up a PowerColor or Sapphire Radeon HD 4850.

Q I want to buy a cell phone with a big screen with a high resolution and excellent video quality. Secondly, I want very good sound quality comparable to iPods and Sandisk Sansas. My price range is from Rs 10,000 to 15,000. The main thing is that it should be a perfect media companion. The camera quality should be decent as an over performing camera is not required. I was thinking of buying only Sony Ericsson phones as my first phone was Sony Ericsson and I would like to stick to the company. Please give a recommendation even if the price of the phone exceeds my range. I was thinking of the SE Aino.

Adi Mukherjee

A If you are looking to grossly overshoot your budget the Aino is for you, but be prepared to shell out around Rs. 26,000. Else spend Rs. 15,000 and get the Nokia 5800 Xpress Music.

Q I am planning to buy a good sound card for around Rs.3,000. It should be good for Music and OK for games. I am considering Creative X-fi Xtreme Audio. Is this OK? Also please clarify some doubts. Is Asus Xonar DX better than Creative X-Fi Xtreme Audio? I have a budget 5.1 speakers Creative SBS A500, Can I experience the power of the sound card with this speaker? What is the price of these cards?

C.Karthik

A I recommend the ASUS Xonar DX, a good sound card for Rs. 3,600 or so. ASUS is considered to use quality materials on their soundcards. **d**

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